Exchange Lifecycle Policies — Microsoft Purview

Implementation Solution Guide

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Executive Summary — Exchange Lifecycle Policies in Microsoft Purview

Mailboxes grow without limit unless something governs the lifecycle of the mail inside them. Left unaddressed, that is two liabilities at once: a **compliance gap** — you cannot demonstrate that mail is kept as long as your schedule requires, and only that long — and a **data-risk exposure** — years of old messages, emptied Deleted Items, and junk accumulating in every mailbox as discoverable, breachable content. This solution closes both by delivering **Exchange-focused lifecycle policies** in **Microsoft Purview**, end to end.

It gives a competent M365/compliance administrator a repeatable way to stand up **two complementary engines**: **Purview Data Lifecycle Management retention** (the compliance-grade "keep, then defensibly delete" control that overrides user deletion for the required period) and **Exchange messaging records management** (the housekeeping engine that ages out Deleted Items and Junk and tiers old mail to the archive) — configured to your schedule, scoped to a pilot ring, validated with explicit pass/fail gates, and only then expanded.

This is a complete, deploy-it-carefully package, written for the administrator implementing Exchange retention and cleanup for the first time.

What you get

• A plain-language Solution Overview of the two engines, how they interact (principles of retention/precedence), and why retention **delete is high-impact and has no simulation mode**.

• A Requirements Guide with verify / implement-if-missing for every prerequisite — licensing, the two PowerShell connections, the records schedule, legal holds, cleanup/archive design, and the pilot ring.

• An Implementation Guide of precise, ordered steps that configures both engines **scoped to a pilot**, supports a **retain-first** deployment, names every policy/tag/scope, and includes rollback.

• Five PowerShell scripts: a lifecycle discovery inventory, a scope-manifest helper, a configuration helper (`-WhatIf`/retain-first by default), a coverage/health report, and a PASS/GAP readiness gate — read-only or `-WhatIf` by default, no credentials in code.

• Testing and Troubleshooting guides, including a **blast-radius** check that proves nothing outside scope is touched.

What this delivers

Mail retained for exactly as long as the schedule requires and no longer; Deleted Items and Junk aged out on a set cadence; old mail moved to the archive to keep primary mailboxes lean; and every destructive behavior proven on a bounded pilot before it reaches production mailboxes.

The deployment model

Assess → Design → Configure → Pilot (limited scope / retain-first) → Validate → Expand (enforce).

Scope boundary

This solution provides the **technical method and evidence**. The **retention schedule** (how long mail is kept, when it may be deleted), any **legal hold**, and the decision to apply an irreversible **Preservation Lock** are **records, privacy, and legal determinations** deferred to those functions — not technical defaults and not the administrator's call (see `global-requirements-purview.md` §5). Because retention delete is largely irreversible and has no simulation mode, the pilot ring is the safety mechanism.

Outcome

Exchange mail governed on policy in Microsoft Purview — kept, cleaned, and tiered exactly as the schedule directs, piloted and validated before enforcement — so the capability is in place, defensible, and evidenced.

Solution Overview — Exchange Lifecycle Policies in Microsoft Purview

What this solution delivers

Mailboxes grow forever unless something tells mail when to **stay** and when to **go**. Left alone, that is two problems at once: a **compliance gap** (you cannot show that mail is kept for as long as the schedule requires — and only as long) and a **data-risk exposure** (years of old messages, deleted items, and junk sitting in every mailbox as discoverable, breachable content). This solution closes both by delivering **Exchange-focused lifecycle policies** in **Microsoft Purview**: a **retention** side that keeps mail for the required period, and a **cleanup** side that removes or archives mail once it is past its useful life — configured to your schedule, piloted on a bounded scope, validated with pass/fail gates, and operable.

This solution walks a competent-but-novice administrator through a **complete, repeatable Exchange lifecycle deployment** built from **two complementary engines**:

1. **Purview Data Lifecycle Management retention (the "keep" and "keep-then-delete" engine).** A

retention policy scoped to **Exchange mailboxes** (and, where in scope, Exchange **public folders**) with a **retention rule** that says *retain for N, then delete* — or *retain only*, or *delete only* — applied per the schedule your records function sets. This is the compliance-grade control: retention overrides user deletion (content is preserved in the Recoverable Items folder even if the user empties it) for the duration of the retain period.

1. **Exchange (MRM) messaging records management (the "housekeeping / cleanup" engine).** A **retention

policy **made of** retention tags **that quietly age mail out of noisy folders — permanently delete** Deleted Items **and** Junk Email **after a set age, and (optionally)** move older mail to the archive mailbox **with a default policy tag — run by the** Managed Folder Assistant**. This is the hygiene control that keeps primary mailboxes lean.

The two are designed to work **together**: Purview retention guarantees the floor (mail is kept long enough and is defensibly removed at end-of-life), while MRM handles day-to-day cleanup and archive tiering. This solution configures both, names every policy/tag/scope, pilots on a limited ring **before** any destructive

action reaches production mailboxes, validates, and only then expands.

Read this first — retention deletion is high-impact and there is no "simulation" toggle

Unlike DLP or auto-labeling, **Purview retention policies do not have a simulation/test mode**. When a retention rule includes a **delete** action, mail **past the retention age is permanently removed** — this is real, and for most tenants **irreversible** once the Recoverable Items window passes. Two principles therefore run through every step:

- **Pilot by SCOPE, not by simulation.** The safe pilot here is a **small, named pilot ring** (a handful of mailboxes / a pilot group) and, where you want extra safety, starting the retention rule as **retain-only** (no delete) or with a deliberately long test window, **validating**, and adding the delete action only after the gate passes. Never point a keep-**then**-delete rule at the whole tenant on day one.
- **The schedule is a records/legal determination, not a technical default.** *How long* mail must be kept, *when* it may be deleted, and *which* mail is subject to legal hold are decided by your **records-management, compliance, privacy, and legal** functions — not by this solution and not by the administrator. This solution provides the **technical method and the evidence**; the retention schedule and any hold come from the owners who set them (see `global-requirements-purview.md` §5).

> ***Preservation Lock is irreversible.*** *If your regulatory obligations require an immutable, can-never-be-shortened retention policy, Purview offers* ***Preservation Lock*** *— but once locked, the policy* ***cannot be disabled, deleted, or made less restrictive by anyone, including a Global Administrator****. Treat locking as a separate, records-approved decision; this solution keeps policies* ***unlocked*** *unless your records function explicitly directs otherwise.*

How the pieces fit

- **Retention policy (Purview) → retention rule.** The **policy** defines *where* it applies (Exchange mailboxes, public folders) and *to whom* (all mailboxes, a static list, or an **adaptive scope**). The **rule** defines *the behavior*: `Retain` (keep), `Delete` (remove), or `KeepAndDelete` (retain N, then delete), with the duration measured from when content was created or last modified. Retention **wins over user deletion** while the retain period runs.
- **MRM retention policy → retention tags.** An MRM **policy** is a bundle of **tags**: a **Default Policy Tag (DPT) **applies to all untagged items (e.g. *move to archive after 2 years*),** Retention Policy Tags (RPTs) **apply to specific default folders (e.g. *Deleted Items → permanently delete after 30 days*), and optional** Personal Tags **users can apply themselves. Assigned to a mailbox and run by the** Managed Folder Assistant**, this is the cleanup/archive engine.
- **The archive mailbox (optional tier).** Enabling the **online archive** (and **auto-expanding archive** where licensed) gives MoveToArchive tags somewhere to move old mail to — shrinking the primary mailbox while keeping the content searchable and within retention.
- **Precedence, understood.** When multiple retention settings apply, Purview follows a defined **principles of retention** order (retain wins over delete; longest retention wins; explicit wins over default). This solution names each object so precedence is deliberate, not accidental.

The standard deployment model

Every step follows the same repeatable model, with an explicit **pass/fail gate** between phases:

Assess → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (limited scope / retain-first)** → **Validate** → **Expand (enforce).**

• **Assess** — confirm licensing (retention is available on **Exchange Online Plan 2 / M365 E3+**;

adaptive scopes and auto-expanding archive have their own plan gates — **verify your licensing/ tenant**), roles, the in-scope mailboxes, the **records schedule**, and legal-hold status.

• **Design** — with records/legal, decide the **retention schedule** (retain N, then delete? retain

only?), the **cleanup** tags (Deleted Items / Junk age-out, archive DPT), the **pilot ring**, and **name every object**.

• **Configure** — create the Purview retention policy + rule scoped to the **pilot**, and the MRM

policy + tags; assign the MRM policy to pilot mailboxes.

• **Pilot** — run on the pilot ring only; where extra safety is wanted, retain-only first. Confirm

mail is being kept/moved/cleaned as intended and **nothing outside scope is touched**.

• **Validate** — run the pass/fail gates in `05-testing.md`.

• **Expand** — widen the Purview policy scope (to all mailboxes / an adaptive scope) and add/enable the

delete action **only** after the gate passes.

What's in the box

• This overview, a **Requirements** guide, an ordered **Implementation** guide, **Testing** (pass/fail

gates), **Troubleshooting**, **Best Practices**, and a **Deliverables Summary** + **Executive Summary**.

• **Five PowerShell tools** (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Exchange Online PowerShell / Graph): a

lifecycle **discovery** inventory, a **scope** manifest helper, a **configuration** helper (`-WhatIf`/retain-first by default, applies only with `-Commit`), a coverage/health **report**, and a PASS/GAP **readiness** gate — read-only or `-WhatIf` by default; **no credentials in code**.

> ***Sources:*** *Microsoft Learn — *Learn about retention policies & retention labels*, *Create and configure retention policies*, *Principles of retention*, *Preservation Lock*, *Adaptive scopes* (Purview Data Lifecycle Management); *Retention tags and retention policies (MRM)*, *Set up an archive and retention policy*, *Enable auto-expanding archiving*, and *Managed Folder Assistant* (Exchange Online). Retention/lifecycle capability is **licensing-dependent** and the Purview portal is **evolving** — **verify capability availability and portal paths against your licensing/tenant** rather than assuming.*

Requirements — Exchange Lifecycle Policies in Microsoft Purview

Confirm every prerequisite below **before** you configure anything. Category-level prerequisites (tenant, licensing model, least-privilege roles, S&C PowerShell / Graph toolchain, in-scope data sources,

compliance/records/privacy/legal stakeholders, pilot scope + change control) are in `global-requirements-purview.md` — reference them; they are **not** repeated here. The items below are the ones **specific to Exchange lifecycle policies** and their two engines: **Purview Data Lifecycle Management retention** and **Exchange (MRM) messaging records management**.

Each requirement is written as **Description · Why · Verify · Implement if missing.**

> *The retention **schedule** (how long mail is kept, when it may be deleted) and any **legal hold** are **records/legal determinations**, not technical defaults — see `global-requirements-purview.md` §5. Several requirements below are hard gates because retention **delete** is destructive and, past the recovery window, **irreversible**.*

R1. Licensing for Exchange retention + MRM + archive

Description: Microsoft 365 / Exchange Online plans that unlock the pieces you use: **Purview retention policies** for Exchange (available with **Exchange Online Plan 2**, included in **Microsoft 365 E3/E5** and equivalents); the **online archive mailbox** (Plan 2 / E3+) and **auto-expanding archiving** (E3/E5 or Exchange Online archiving add-on) if you use MoveToArchive cleanup; and **adaptive scopes** (require **E5 / E5 Compliance**) if you scope the retention policy dynamically. **Why:** Retention, archive, and adaptive scoping are plan-gated; the control will not be available without the right plan, and in-scope mailboxes must be licensed. **Verify:** Microsoft 365 admin center → **Billing** → **Licenses**; in the Purview portal, **Data Lifecycle Management** → **Retention Policies** is present and **Exchange** is a selectable location; archive availability shows per mailbox. Cross-check advanced features against the *Microsoft Purview service description* — **verify against your licensing/tenant. Implement if missing:** Acquire/assign the required SKUs/add-ons before configuring. If you lack E5, use **static scoping** (a mailbox list / group) instead of adaptive scopes.

R2. Least-privilege roles — retention (Purview) and MRM (Exchange)

Description: The least-privilege roles for each engine, mapped to **named** people:

- **Retention Management** or **Compliance Administrator / Compliance Data Administrator** in the Purview portal to author **retention policies and rules**.
- **Retention Management** role (Exchange Online RBAC) to create **MRM retention tags/policies** and assign them to mailboxes; **Recipient Management** where you also change mailbox settings/archive.
- **Global Administrator** only where genuinely required (e.g. first-time Purview role assignment).

Why: Purview retention and Exchange MRM use **separate** role models; configuring both requires the matching least-privilege role on each surface, without over-granting. **Verify:** Purview → **Roles & scopes / Permissions** (retention roles); Exchange admin center → **Roles** → **Admin roles** (Retention/Recipient Management). `DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1` reports the role signals it can read. **Implement if missing:** Assign the least-privilege role on each surface under change control.

R3. Exchange Online PowerShell + Security & Compliance PowerShell toolchain

Description: A workstation with the **ExchangeOnlineManagement** module, able to run both `Connect-IPPSSession` (Security & Compliance — for Purview retention policies/rules) and `Connect-ExchangeOnline` (Exchange Online — for MRM tags/policies, mailbox assignment, and the Managed Folder Assistant), with a modern-auth / MFA-capable admin account. **Why:** The two engines are configured through **two different connections** in the same module; the provided scripts use both. Graph is used only for read-only mailbox/scope signals. **Verify:** `Connect-IPPSSession` and `Connect-ExchangeOnline` both succeed; `Get-RetentionCompliancePolicy` and `Get-RetentionPolicy` each return without error. **Implement if missing:** `Install-Module ExchangeOnlineManagement`; confirm modern-auth sign-in for both connections before running steps.

R4. The retention schedule (records determination) — retain, delete, or keep-then-delete

Description: A **documented retention schedule for mail**, approved by records/legal: the **retain period** (e.g. retain 7 years), whether mail is **deleted at end-of-life** (`KeepAndDelete`), **retained only** (`Retain`), or **deleted by age** with no retain guarantee (`Delete`), and whether the period runs from **created** or **last-modified** date. **Why:** This determines exactly what the retention rule does to real mail; a delete action is destructive. It is a **records/legal determination**, not a technical choice. **Verify:** Confirm the approved schedule **in writing**, including the disposition action and duration, before you author the rule. **Implement if missing: Stop** and obtain it from records/legal. Do not enable a delete action on a schedule you cannot cite. (See `global-requirements-purview.md` §5.)

R5. Legal-hold / eDiscovery status of the in-scope mailboxes

Description: Knowledge of which in-scope mailboxes are under a **litigation hold**, **eDiscovery hold**, or an existing **retention policy/label** that preserves content — and confirmation that the new cleanup/delete behavior will not conflict with an active hold. **Why:** A hold **overrides** delete (held content is preserved regardless), which is correct — but you must know it, because it changes what "cleanup" actually removes and can mask a mis-scoped rule. Removing or shortening retention on held data is a legal matter. **Verify:** Purview → **Data Lifecycle Management / eDiscovery** and Exchange **litigation hold** status per mailbox; `DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1` reports litigation-hold and existing-policy signals it can read. **Implement if missing:** Reconcile holds with records/legal **before** enabling delete/cleanup; exclude or defer any mailbox whose hold status is unresolved.

R6. Cleanup design — MRM tags and the archive tier

Description: The **MRM cleanup design**, agreed with the business: which default folders are aged out (e.g. **Deleted Items** and **Junk Email** → permanently delete after 30 days), whether a **Default Policy Tag** moves old mail to the **archive** (e.g. move to archive after 2 years), and whether users get **Personal Tags**. Plus whether the **online archive** (and **auto-expanding archive**) is enabled where MoveToArchive is used. **Why:** MRM is the hygiene engine; its tags act on real folders and (for delete tags) permanently remove mail. MoveToArchive needs an archive mailbox to move to. **Verify:** Exchange → **Compliance management** → **Retention tags/policies**; archive enabled per mailbox (`Get-Mailbox -Archive`); `DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1` reports existing MRM tags/policies and archive status. **Implement if missing:** Define the tag set and (if used) enable archive mailboxes before assigning the MRM policy.

R7. Pilot scope and change control (limited ring / retain-first)

Description: A **named pilot ring** — a small mailbox list or mail-enabled group `SG-DLCEXO-Pilot` — and agreement to deploy the Purview retention policy and MRM policy to that ring **first**, under **change control**, before any tenant-wide or delete-enabled expansion. Because retention has **no simulation mode**, the pilot is the safety mechanism; optionally start the retention rule **retain-only** and add delete after validation. **Why:** Retention delete and MRM delete are high-impact and largely irreversible; the pilot ring proves the policies keep/move/clean the right mail **without** touching anyone else, and lets you tune before enforcing broadly. **Verify:** Confirm the pilot group exists and its membership, that a retain-first option was considered, and a change window/approval path. `DLCEXO-Set-Scope.ps1` (read-only) records the pilot scope manifest; `DLCEXO-Configure.ps1` defaults to `-WhatIf`. **Implement if missing:** Create the pilot group, deploy to it first, and agree change control before expanding scope or enabling delete.

R8. Managed Folder Assistant / processing expectations

Description: Awareness that MRM tags are applied by the **Managed Folder Assistant (MFA)**, which runs on its own **work cycle** (roughly once per day, best-effort) — cleanup/archive is **not instantaneous** — and that you can trigger a processing pass for a pilot mailbox with `Start-ManagedFolderAssistant`. **Why:** Test expectations must match reality: if you assign a tag and check a minute later, nothing will have changed. Validation must allow for the MFA cycle (or a manual trigger on the pilot mailbox). **Verify:** `Start-ManagedFolderAssistant -Identity <pilotMailbox>` succeeds on a pilot mailbox; `Get-MailboxFolderStatistics` / message age reflects processing after the pass. **Implement if missing:** Plan validation around the MFA cycle; trigger it manually on pilot mailboxes to observe results within a test window.

Global Requirements — Microsoft Purview Solutions

These requirements apply to **every** solution in the **Purview** category (implementing and managing Microsoft Purview, sensitivity & retention labels, DLP, data lifecycle & records, insider risk, communication compliance, audit, data security posture management, and data governance). Verify each before starting a solution's implementation steps.

> ***Vendor boundary (applies to every Purview solution).*** *The **Microsoft Purview portal** (purview.microsoft.com), the **Microsoft 365 admin center**, **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession`), and **Microsoft Graph** are authored at exact, current click-by-click / cmdlet detail from Microsoft's public documentation. Microsoft Purview features are heavily **licensing-/plan-dependent** (many require **Microsoft 365 E5** or the **E5 Compliance** add-on; some are in preview) and the portal is **actively evolving** — capability availability and portal paths are **cited or flagged "verify your licensing/tenant"**, never asserted or invented. **Regulatory, records-retention, and legal determinations** (retention schedules, records file plans, legal holds, insider-risk case actions, regulatory applicability) are **deferred to the organization's compliance, records, privacy, and legal functions** — the solutions provide the technical configuration method and evidence, not the determination. Automation is **PowerShell** (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph) — never with hardcoded credentials or secrets.*

1. Microsoft 365 tenant with the required Purview/compliance licensing

- **Description:** A Microsoft 365 tenant with the **compliance licensing** the capability requires

(E3 for baseline; **E5 / E5 Compliance** for advanced DLP, auto-labeling, insider risk, communication compliance, Audit Premium, DSPM, etc.).

- **Why required:** Most Purview capabilities are plan-gated; the feature won't be available without the right plan.
- **How to verify:** In the M365 admin center confirm the subscription/add-ons; check the feature is visible in the Purview portal.
- **How to implement if missing:** Assign/purchase the required licensing before starting.

2. Purview roles (least-privilege) and portal access

- **Description:** Access with the least-privilege **Purview / compliance role** the solution names (e.g. Compliance Administrator, Compliance Data Administrator, Information Protection, Records Management, Insider Risk, eDiscovery, Audit roles), with Global Administrator only where required.
- **Why required:** Purview uses fine-grained role groups; configuration requires the matching role.
- **How to verify:** Purview portal → **Roles & scopes / Permissions** — confirm the role membership.
- **How to implement if missing:** Assign the least-privilege role group under change control.

3. Security & Compliance PowerShell + Graph toolchain

- **Description:** A workstation with **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession` via the ExchangeOnlineManagement module) and **Microsoft Graph PowerShell**, modern-auth / MFA-capable admin.
- **Why required:** Configuration, automation, and the provided scripts run through these.
- **How to verify:** `Connect-IPPSSession` and `Connect-MgGraph` succeed with the admin account.
- **How to implement if missing:** Install the modules and confirm modern-auth sign-in before running steps.

4. Data sources & scope in scope

- **Description:** The **workloads and data sources** in scope (Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, endpoints/devices, and — for data governance — the broader data estate) and a **data-classification / sensitivity** intent to drive labels, DLP, and retention.
- **Why required:** Purview policies key off the in-scope workloads and the classification scheme.
- **How to verify:** Confirm the in-scope workloads and the classification/sensitivity approach with stakeholders.
- **How to implement if missing:** Define the scope and classification intent before authoring policies.

5. Compliance, records, privacy & legal stakeholders

• **Description:** Engagement with the **compliance, records-management, privacy, security, and legal**

stakeholders whose policies the configuration must satisfy (retention schedules, records file plans, regulatory obligations, insider-risk and communication-compliance policy, legal hold).

• **Why required:** Purview configuration must align to enterprise policy and legal/records requirements,

not technical defaults; several capabilities have HR/legal sensitivity.

• **How to verify:** Confirm the applicable policies, the records schedule, and named approvers.

• **How to implement if missing:** Identify the owners and capture the requirements before configuring.

6. A pilot scope and change control

• **Description:** A **pilot scope** (users/sites/policies in simulation or a limited ring) to validate

on before tenant-wide enforcement, and a **change-control** process — most Purview policies support a **simulation / test / disabled** mode that MUST be used before enforcement.

• **Why required:** Every solution follows an **Assess → Design → Configure → Pilot (simulate) → Validate

→ Expand (enforce)** model; DLP, labels, retention, and insider-risk changes are high-impact.

• **How to verify:** Confirm a named pilot scope, that simulation/test mode is available, and a change

window/approval path.

• **How to implement if missing:** Define the pilot and agree change control before enforcing anything.

*The deployment model across every Purview solution is the same: **Assess** → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (simulate/test)** → **Validate** → **Expand (enforce)**, with explicit pass/fail gates and a documented rollback. Automation is delivered as **PowerShell** (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph) — never with hardcoded credentials or secrets. Regulatory/records/legal determinations are deferred to the relevant governance functions.*

Implementation — Exchange Lifecycle Policies in Microsoft Purview

Follow these steps in order. The model is **Assess** → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (limited scope / retain-first)** → **Validate** → **Expand (enforce)** with an explicit **pass/fail gate** before you widen scope or enable any delete action. Every object is named so precedence and scope are deliberate.

> ***Before you start:*** *retention **delete is destructive and largely irreversible**, and Purview retention has **no simulation mode**. The pilot ring is your safety net. Do not point a keep-**then**-delete rule at all mailboxes on day one. The retention **schedule** and any **hold** come from records/legal (`02-requirements.md` R4/R5), not from this guide.*

Named objects used throughout (rename to your convention, keep them consistent):

Object	Name	Engine
Pilot ring (mail-enabled security group)	`SG-DLCEXO-Pilot`	scope
Purview retention policy (Exchange)	`DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot`	Purview DLM
Purview retention rule	`DLCEXO-Rule-Exchange-Keep7yrThenDelete`	Purview DLM
MRM (cleanup) retention policy	`DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard`	Exchange MRM
RPT — Deleted Items age-out	`DLCEXO-Tag-DeletedItems-30d`	Exchange MRM
RPT — Junk Email age-out	`DLCEXO-Tag-JunkEmail-30d`	Exchange MRM
DPT — move old mail to archive	`DLCEXO-Tag-Default-MoveToArchive-2yr`	Exchange MRM

(Durations shown — 7 years / 30 days / 2 years — are placeholders. Use the values your records schedule specifies.)

Phase 1 — Assess

1. **Confirm licensing and roles** (`02-requirements.md` R1/R2). In the Purview portal confirm **Data Lifecycle Management → Retention Policies **is available and** Exchange **is a selectable location; confirm you hold** Retention Management / Compliance Administrator**. Confirm** Retention Management** in Exchange for MRM.

1. **Run the discovery inventory.** From a workstation with `Connect-IPPSSession` **and** `Connect-ExchangeOnline`:

```
.\DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1 -IncludeMailboxSample
```

Review existing Purview retention policies scoped to Exchange, existing MRM tags/policies, the **org default MRM policy**, archive status, and any **litigation-hold** mailboxes. Pre-existing retention or holds change what your new policy will (and won't) remove — reconcile them now. **Gate:** you have a clear picture of what already governs these mailboxes. Unresolved holds → stop and reconcile with legal (R5).

Phase 2 — Design (with records/legal)

1. **Fix the retention schedule** (R4). Record, in writing: retain period, disposition (`Retain` / `Delete` / `KeepAndDelete`), and whether the clock runs from **created** or **modified** date. Example working schedule: *retain 7 years from creation, then delete.*

1. **Fix the cleanup design** (R6). Decide the MRM tags: Deleted Items → permanently delete after 30 days; Junk Email → permanently delete after 30 days; DPT → move to archive after 2 years (only if archive mailboxes are/will be enabled). Decide whether users get Personal Tags.

1. **Fix the pilot ring** (R7). Confirm `SG-DLCEXO-Pilot` exists with a small, representative membership. Record the scope manifest:

```
.\DLCEXO-Set-Scope.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" -RetainDays 2555 -Disposition KeepAndDelete
```

(2555 ≈ 7 years.) This writes a read-only manifest to configure against; it changes nothing. **Gate:** schedule, cleanup design, and pilot ring are all approved and named.

Phase 3 — Configure (scoped to the pilot)

3a. Purview retention policy + rule (the keep / keep-then-delete engine)

1. **Create the retention policy scoped to the pilot**, Exchange location only. Prefer the helper in `-WhatIf` first, then `-Commit`:

```
# Preview (default): prints the plan, changes nothing
.\DLCEXO-Configure.ps1 -PolicyName "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot" `
    -RuleName "DLCEXO-Rule-Exchange-Keep7yrThenDelete" `
    -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" -RetainDays 2555 -Disposition KeepAndDelete -WhatIf

# Apply
.\DLCEXO-Configure.ps1 -PolicyName "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot" `
    -RuleName "DLCEXO-Rule-Exchange-Keep7yrThenDelete" `
    -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" -RetainDays 2555 -Disposition KeepAndDelete -Commit
```

Under the covers this is `New-RetentionCompliancePolicy -ExchangeLocation <pilot members>` then `New-RetentionComplianceRule -Policy <policy> -RetentionDuration 2555 -RetentionComplianceAction KeepAndDelete -ExpirationDateOption CreationAgeInDays`. **Retain-first option:** pass `-Disposition Retain` to deploy keep-only, validate, then re-run with `KeepAndDelete` to add delete.

> *Scoping to a group targets **its current members' mailboxes**; membership changes do not auto-re-scope a static policy. For dynamic membership use an **adaptive scope** (E5) at expand time.*

1. **Do NOT enable Preservation Lock** at pilot. Locking is a separate, records-approved, irreversible decision (`01-solution-overview.md`).

3b. Exchange MRM policy + tags (the cleanup / archive engine)

1. **Create the retention tags**, then bundle them into the MRM policy, then assign to pilot mailboxes.

The `-Commit` path of the helper performs these; the equivalent Exchange cmdlets are:

```
New-RetentionPolicyTag "DLCEXO-Tag-DeletedItems-30d" -Type DeletedItems `
    -RetentionEnabled $true -AgeLimitForRetention 30 -RetentionAction PermanentlyDelete
New-RetentionPolicyTag "DLCEXO-Tag-JunkEmail-30d" -Type JunkEmail `
    -RetentionEnabled $true -AgeLimitForRetention 30 -RetentionAction PermanentlyDelete
New-RetentionPolicyTag "DLCEXO-Tag-Default-MoveToArchive-2yr" -Type All `
    -RetentionEnabled $true -AgeLimitForRetention 730 -RetentionAction MoveToArchive
New-RetentionPolicy "DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard" -RetentionPolicyTagLinks `
    "DLCEXO-Tag-DeletedItems-30d","DLCEXO-Tag-JunkEmail-30d","DLCEXO-Tag-Default-MoveToArchive-2yr"
```

Include the DPT (`-Type All … MoveToArchive`) **only if** archive mailboxes are enabled for the pilot users (`Enable-Mailbox -Archive`). Assign to each pilot mailbox: `Set-Mailbox -Identity <pilotMailbox> -RetentionPolicy "DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard"`.

1. **Trigger a processing pass** on a pilot mailbox so you can observe results within the test window:

```
Start-ManagedFolderAssistant -Identity <pilotMailbox>
```

Gate (Configure): both policies exist, are scoped to the pilot only, and the MFA has run at least once on a pilot mailbox. `DLCEXO-Report.ps1` should show the pilot mailboxes as covered.

Phase 4 — Pilot & Validate

1. **Validate on the pilot ring** using `05-testing.md`. Confirm: retention is **preserving** mail

against user deletion (Recoverable Items holds it) for in-scope pilot mailboxes; MRM is **cleaning** Deleted Items / Junk on schedule; MoveToArchive is **moving** old mail to the archive; and **no mailbox outside** `SG-DLCEXO-Pilot` **is affected**.

1. **Run the readiness gate:**

```
.\DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1
```

All checks **PASS** (or every **GAP** is understood and accepted by records/legal) → proceed. Any unexplained GAP, or any out-of-scope mailbox touched → **stop, fix, re-pilot.**

Phase 5 — Expand (enforce)

1. **Widen the Purview retention scope** only after the gate passes: re-scope

`DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot` from the pilot group to **all mailboxes** or an **adaptive scope** (E5), and — if you piloted retain-only — **add the delete action** now (`Set-RetentionComplianceRule -RetentionComplianceAction KeepAndDelete`). Rename the policy to drop `-Pilot` if you wish, keeping the name consistent in your records.

1. **Assign the MRM policy more broadly** (or set it as the mailbox default for new mailboxes) under

change control, staging in rings.

1. **Record the evidence.** Export the final `DLCEXO-Report.ps1` and `DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1`

output as the deployment evidence (policy names, scope, durations, coverage), and hand the retention-schedule mapping back to records.

Rollback

• **Purview retention (keep-only or not yet deleted):** `Set-RetentionCompliancePolicy -Enabled $false`

(unless **Preservation Locked** — locked policies cannot be disabled by anyone). Removing a policy before its delete action has run leaves mail intact.

• **Purview retention after deletion has run:** deleted mail past the Recoverable Items window is

not recoverable — this is why you pilot and retain-first. There is no rollback for already- deleted content.

• **MRM cleanup:** unassign with `Set-Mailbox -RetentionPolicy $null` (or a benign policy) and the MFA

stops applying the tags going forward; **already-deleted** items past recovery are not restorable. **MoveToArchive** is reversible in effect (content moved to the archive is still the user's and searchable), but re-homing it to the primary is a manual/eDiscovery operation.

• Always capture the current state with `DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1` **before** changes so rollback targets a

known-good baseline.

Testing & Validation — Exchange Lifecycle Policies in Microsoft Purview

Run these gates on the **pilot ring** (`SG-DLCEXO-Pilot`) before expanding scope or enabling any delete action. Each test has an explicit **PASS / FAIL** signal. A FAIL means **stop, fix, and re-pilot** — do not widen scope or add a delete action on a failing gate. Because retention **delete is destructive and has no simulation mode**, the most important gate is **G5: nothing outside scope is touched.**

> *Allow for the **Managed Folder Assistant** cycle (roughly daily, best-effort). For MRM tests, trigger a pass first: `Start-ManagedFolderAssistant -Identity <pilotMailbox>`. Purview retention can also take time to fully apply after a policy is created.*

G1. Scope is correct — only pilot mailboxes are in the policy

• **How:** `Get-RetentionCompliancePolicy "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot" | Select ExchangeLocation`

and confirm it lists **only** the pilot members. `Get-Mailbox <pilotMailbox> | Select RetentionPolicy` shows `DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard`. Run `DLCEXO-Report.ps1`.

• **PASS:** the Purview policy's ExchangeLocation resolves to pilot members only, and pilot mailboxes

carry the MRM policy.

• **FAIL:** any non-pilot mailbox appears in scope, or a pilot mailbox is missing the MRM policy.

G2. Retention rule is configured as designed

• **How:** `Get-RetentionComplianceRule -Policy "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot" | Select Name, RetentionDuration, RetentionComplianceAction, ExpirationDateOption`.

• **PASS:** duration, action (`Retain` / `KeepAndDelete` per your approved schedule), and date basis

match `02-requirements.md` R4 exactly.

• **FAIL:** any value differs from the approved schedule (especially a **delete** action that records/

legal did not approve).

G3. Retention preserves mail against user deletion (the "keep" guarantee)

• **How:** In a pilot mailbox, delete a test message and empty Deleted Items (and empty Recoverable

Items "Deletions" from the client where possible). Confirm via **eDiscovery content search** or `Get-MailboxFolderStatistics <pilotMailbox> -FolderScope RecoverableItems` that the item is still **preserved** (in Recoverable Items) within the retain period.

- **PASS:** the "deleted" item is still recoverable/preserved — retention overrode the user deletion.
- **FAIL:** the item is gone with an active retain rule → policy not applied yet (allow more time) or mis-scoped.

G4. MRM cleanup ages out the right folders

- **How:** Trigger `Start-ManagedFolderAssistant -Identity <pilotMailbox>`. On a pilot mailbox with a message older than the tag age in **Deleted Items** / **Junk Email**, confirm the item is removed after the pass; confirm the **MoveToArchive** DPT moved older primary-folder mail into the **archive** mailbox (`Get-MailboxFolderStatistics <pilotMailbox> -Archive`).
- **PASS:** aged Deleted Items/Junk are permanently removed; older mail appears in the archive; newer mail and other folders are untouched.
- **FAIL:** nothing changed after an MFA pass (check tag age/enabled, archive enabled for MoveToArchive), or a folder outside the tag design was affected.

G5. Blast-radius check — NO mailbox outside the pilot is affected

- **How:** Pick 2–3 **non-pilot** mailboxes. Confirm `Get-Mailbox <nonPilot> | Select RetentionPolicy` is **not** `DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard`, and that they are **not** in the Purview policy's ExchangeLocation. Confirm no cleanup/deletion occurred in them. Run `DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1`.
- **PASS:** non-pilot mailboxes are untouched by both engines.
- **FAIL:** any non-pilot mailbox carries the policy or shows cleanup → **immediately** roll back scope (`03-implementation.md`) before continuing.

G6. Holds are honored (no held mail deleted)

- **How:** For any pilot mailbox on litigation/eDiscovery hold (from `DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1`), confirm that mail which would otherwise be deleted by MRM/retention is **still preserved** (holds override delete).
- **PASS:** held content is preserved despite delete tags/rules.
- **FAIL:** held content was removed → **stop**, treat as a legal incident, and escalate to legal.

G7. Readiness gate is green

- **How:** `.\DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1`.
- **PASS:** every check returns **PASS**, or each **GAP** is documented and accepted by records/legal.
- **FAIL:** any unexplained GAP.

Exit criteria (before Expand)

All of **G1–G7 PASS** (or GAPs accepted in writing), evidence exported from `DLCEXO-Report.ps1` and `DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1`, and records/legal sign-off on record. Only then widen the Purview scope / add the delete action / broaden the MRM assignment per `03-implementation.md` Phase 5.

Troubleshooting — Exchange Lifecycle Policies in Microsoft Purview

Field issues and how to resolve them, grouped by engine. Start every investigation with a read-only baseline: `.\DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1 -IncludeMailboxSample` and `.\DLCEXO-Report.ps1`. Remember the two timing realities: **Purview retention** can take time to fully provision after a policy is created, and **MRM cleanup** runs on the **Managed Folder Assistant** cycle (roughly daily, best-effort).

Connection & permissions

`Get-RetentionCompliancePolicy` / `New-RetentionCompliancePolicy` not recognized or access denied.

- You are not connected to **Security & Compliance PowerShell**, or lack the role. Run

`Connect-IPPSSession` with a **Retention Management / Compliance Administrator** account (`02-requirements.md` R2/R3). These cmdlets do **not** exist in a plain `Connect-ExchangeOnline` session.

`New-RetentionPolicyTag` / `Set-Mailbox -RetentionPolicy` fails.

- Those are **Exchange Online** cmdlets — run `Connect-ExchangeOnline` (separate from IPPS) with the

Retention Management role. The scripts expect **both** connections open.

"You don't have sufficient permissions" on `Set-Mailbox`.

- MRM assignment needs **Recipient Management** (or Retention Management with recipient write). Assign

the least-privilege role rather than escalating to Global Admin.

Purview retention (keep / keep-then-delete)

Policy created but mail isn't being preserved yet.

- Retention policies take time to **provision and apply** after creation (can be hours). Re-check with

`Get-RetentionCompliancePolicy -Identity <name> -DistributionDetail | Select DistributionStatus`. Wait for distribution to complete before concluding the "keep" gate (G3) failed.

A "deleted" test message really disappeared under an active retain rule.

- Either the policy hasn't finished distributing (above), or the mailbox isn't actually in scope. Run

`DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1` — the **scope = pilot only** check shows whether the mailbox is in `ExchangeLocation`. Retention preserves to **Recoverable Items**; verify there / via eDiscovery, not just the visible folders.

I need to remove a policy but `Set-RetentionCompliancePolicy -Enabled $false` is refused.

- The policy is under **Preservation Lock** — by design it **cannot be disabled, deleted, or shortened

by anyone**, including a Global Admin. This is why this solution keeps policies** unlocked** unless records explicitly directs locking. There is no self-service unlock.

Delete action removed mail I did not expect.

- Check `ExpirationDateOption` (**CreationAgeInDays** vs **ModificationAgeInDays**) — the wrong basis

ages mail differently than intended — and the `RetentionDuration`. Because deletion past the recovery window is **irreversible**, treat this as an incident: freeze expansion, confirm scope, and escalate to records/legal if held or in-scope-but-not-approved mail was affected.

Group-scoped policy isn't covering new members.

- A **static** group scope targets the mailboxes that were members **when scoped**; it does not

auto-re-scope. Either re-run configuration to refresh scope or move to an **adaptive scope** (E5) at expand time (`03-implementation.md` Phase 5; `07-best-practices.md`).

Exchange MRM cleanup (Deleted Items / Junk / archive)

Assigned the MRM policy but nothing has been cleaned.

- The **Managed Folder Assistant** hasn't run yet. Trigger it on the pilot mailbox:

`Start-ManagedFolderAssistant -Identity <pilotMailbox>`, then re-check. Also confirm the tags are **RetentionEnabled = $true** and the item is genuinely **older** than `AgeLimitForRetention`.

MoveToArchive tag isn't moving anything.

- The mailbox has **no archive**. `Get-Mailbox <mbx> | Select ArchiveStatus,ArchiveState` — if there is

no archive, `Enable-Mailbox -Identity <mbx> -Archive` first (licensing permitting), then re-run the MFA. MoveToArchive has nowhere to move mail without an archive.

Cleanup is deleting mail that should be kept.

- A **hold** (litigation/eDiscovery) or a **Purview retain** rule should override an MRM delete

(retain wins over delete — `07-best-practices.md`). If held mail was removed, treat it as a **legal incident** and escalate. Otherwise confirm the tag ages/types match the design (`03-implementation.md` Phase 3b) and that you didn't attach an unintended DPT.

Age limits look right but items persist past the age.

- MFA is **best-effort** and throttled by mailbox size and work-cycle; large mailboxes converge over

multiple cycles. Confirm the tag is linked to the assigned policy (`Get-RetentionPolicy <name> | Select RetentionPolicyTagLinks`) and that the item's folder matches the tag **Type**.

Scope & blast radius

A non-pilot mailbox was affected.

- **Stop and roll back scope immediately** (`03-implementation.md` Rollback): unassign the MRM policy

(`Set-Mailbox -RetentionPolicy $null`) and remove the mailbox from the Purview policy's `ExchangeLocation`. Then re-run `DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1` (the C5 blast-radius check) until it PASSes before continuing. Investigate how the mailbox entered scope (group membership? "All"? adaptive-scope query?).

Readiness gate shows GAP on "scope = pilot only".

- The policy is scoped to **All** or lists mailboxes outside the pilot group. Re-scope to the pilot

before doing anything else — this is the guardrail that keeps a destructive rule off production mailboxes.

Reporting & evidence

`DLCEXO-Report.ps1` **shows no per-mailbox rows.**

- The policy is likely scoped to **All** or an **adaptive scope**, so there are no explicit addresses to

enumerate. Pass `-PilotGroup` to report per-mailbox, or accept that estate-wide scope reports at the policy level.

I need audit evidence of what changed.

- Export `DLCEXO-Report.ps1` and `DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1` output at each phase and keep the

policy/rule/tag names, scope, and durations. For end-to-end change history, use the **unified audit log** (retention config changes are audited) and the Purview policy's own change record.

> *If a symptom isn't covered here, capture a fresh* `DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1` *baseline and re-run* `DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1` *— most issues resolve to (a) not connected to both endpoints, (b) timing (distribution / MFA cycle), (c) scope drift, or (d) a hold correctly overriding a delete. Regulatory, records, and legal questions go to those owners, not the administrator.*

Best Practices — Exchange Lifecycle Policies in Microsoft Purview

Field-proven recommendations for running Exchange retention + cleanup safely. They reinforce the model: **Assess** → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot** → **Validate** → **Expand**, with records/legal owning the schedule.

Treat delete as one-way — pilot and retain-first

- Retention **delete has no simulation mode and is largely irreversible** past the recovery window.

Deploy **keep-only first** on the pilot, validate the "keep" behavior, and add the delete action only after the gate passes. This is the single most important habit in this solution.

- Never point a keep-**then**-delete rule at all mailboxes on day one. Widen scope in **rings**.

Keep the schedule with records, not in the tool

- The retain period, disposition, and legal holds are **records/legal determinations**. Store the approved schedule in your records system and map policy names to it; the Purview policy is the *implementation*, not the *decision*. Re-confirm the schedule at each expansion.

Name and document precedence deliberately

- Use consistent, self-describing names (`DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-*`, `DLCEXO-Tag-*`, `DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-*`) so anyone reading the tenant can see scope and intent.
- Understand **principles of retention**: **retain wins over delete**, **longest retention wins**, **explicit wins over default**. When Purview retention and MRM both apply, expect Purview's preservation to win over an MRM delete — design so this is intentional, not a surprise.

Prefer adaptive scopes for dynamic populations (where licensed)

- A **static** group scope targets *current* members and does not auto-re-scope as membership changes.

For "all mailboxes in Legal" or "all leavers," an **adaptive scope** (E5) keeps membership current automatically. Confirm licensing before relying on it.

Use the archive tier to shrink mailboxes without losing content

- **MoveToArchive** DPTs plus the **online / auto-expanding archive** keep primary mailboxes lean while content stays searchable and within retention. Enable the archive **before** assigning MoveToArchive tags, or the tag has nowhere to move mail to.

Respect the Managed Folder Assistant cadence

- MRM is **best-effort, ~daily**, not instant. Don't judge cleanup on a stopwatch; trigger `Start-ManagedFolderAssistant` on pilot mailboxes for testing, but expect production to converge over a work cycle.

Reconcile with holds every time

- A litigation/eDiscovery hold **overrides** delete (correctly). Always run discovery first so you know which mailboxes are held; never assume "cleanup removed it" for held content, and treat any held-mail deletion as a legal incident.

Preservation Lock is a separate, deliberate decision

- Lock **only** when regulation requires immutability and records has approved it — a locked policy

cannot be shortened, disabled, or deleted by anyone, including a Global Admin. Default to **unlocked**.

Automate read-only, gate the writes

- Run `DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1` / `DLCEXO-Report.ps1` / `DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1` on a schedule for

ongoing assurance (coverage, drift, out-of-scope mailboxes). Keep all write operations behind `-WhatIf` → `-Commit` and change control. **No credentials in scripts** — use interactive modern-auth or a managed identity.

Keep evidence

- Export policy names, scope, durations, and coverage at each phase. "Retention is configured and

validated" is only defensible if you can **show** the scope, the schedule it implements, and the pass/fail gates — that evidence is the deliverable records and auditors actually want.

8. Deliverables Summary — Exchange Lifecycle Policies: Microsoft Purview

Documentation

Document	Purpose
Executive Summary	Business case and what's in the box
1. Solution Overview	The two engines (Purview retention + Exchange MRM cleanup), why deletion is high-impact, precedence, and the Assess→Design→Configure→Pilot→Validate→Expand model (the why)
2. Requirements Guide	Every prerequisite with Verify / Implement-if-missing (licensing, roles, both toolchain connections, the records schedule, holds, cleanup design, pilot ring, MFA cadence)
Global Requirements (Purview)	Category-wide prerequisites, published once
3. Implementation Guide	Exact, ordered steps: assess, design with records/legal, configure retention + MRM scoped to the pilot, pilot (retain-first), validate, expand — each policy/tag/scope named, with rollback
5. Testing Guide	Validation procedures with pass/fail gates — including the blast-radius check that nothing outside scope is touched
6. Troubleshooting Guide	Field issues and remediation

Document	Purpose
7. Best Practices	Field-proven recommendations

Named artifacts

Artifact	Name
Pilot ring (mail-enabled security group)	`SG-DLCEXO-Pilot`
Purview retention policy (Exchange)	`DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot`
Purview retention rule	`DLCEXO-Rule-Exchange-Keep7yrThenDelete`
MRM cleanup retention policy	`DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard`
RPT — Deleted Items age-out	`DLCEXO-Tag-DeletedItems-30d`
RPT — Junk Email age-out	`DLCEXO-Tag-JunkEmail-30d`
DPT — move old mail to archive	`DLCEXO-Tag-Default-MoveToArchive-2yr`

(Durations are placeholders — use the values from your records schedule.)

PowerShell scripts

Script	What it does
`DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1`	Read-only inventory of what already governs the mailboxes: Purview retention policies/rules scoped to Exchange, MRM retention tags/policies, the org default MRM policy, per-mailbox archive + litigation-hold status (Connect-IPPSSession + Connect-ExchangeOnline)
`DLCEXO-Set-Scope.ps1`	Records the pilot/expansion scope — pilot group, target retain duration, disposition, cleanup tags — as a read-only scope manifest to configure against; changes nothing
`DLCEXO-Configure.ps1`	Creates/updates the Purview retention policy + rule (Exchange) and the MRM cleanup policy + tags, scoped to the pilot; **defaults to** `-WhatIf`, applies only with `-Commit`; supports `-Disposition Retain` for retain-first; no secrets in code
`DLCEXO-Report.ps1`	Coverage/health report: which mailboxes are in the Purview policy scope, MRM policy assignment coverage, archive enablement, and mailbox-size signal (read-only)

Script	What it does
`DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1`	Consolidated PASS/GAP pilot gate: licensing/role signal, policy scope = pilot only, rule matches the approved schedule, MRM assigned to pilot, holds honored, and the blast-radius (no out-of-scope mailbox) check (read-only)

What the buyer receives

- This implementation guide as a Word document and PDF.
- All five PowerShell scripts in a single ZIP.
- A repeatable method following the model: Assess → Design → Configure → Pilot → Validate → Expand.

Outcome

Mail governed on policy in Microsoft Purview — retained for as long as the schedule requires and no longer, with Deleted Items/Junk aged out and old mail tiered to the archive — proven on a bounded pilot before any destructive action reaches production, with the retention schedule, holds, and disposition determinations left to the records, privacy, and legal owners who make them.

Appendix A — PowerShell Scripts

Included in the accompanying ZIP. Each script's header documents full usage.

DLCEXO-Configure.ps1

Purpose: Builds the two Exchange lifecycle engines for the pilot ring: (1) a Purview retention policy scoped to Exchange + a retention rule (retain / keep-then-delete), and (2) an Exchange MRM cleanup policy with Deleted Items / Junk age-out tags and an optional MoveToArchive default tag. SAFE BY DEFAULT: prints the exact plan under -WhatIf and does nothing; applies only with -Commit. Supports retain-first (-Disposition Retain) so you can validate the "keep" behavior before ever adding a delete action. HOW TO RUN PowerShell 5.1+ or 7+ with ExchangeOnlineManagement. Connect BOTH endpoints first: Connect-IPPSSession # Purview retention policy/rule Connect-ExchangeOnline # MRM tags/policy + mailbox assignment .\DLCEXO-Configure.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" -RetainDays 2555 -Disposition Retain -WhatIf .\DLCEXO-Configure.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" -RetainDays 2555 -Disposition KeepAndDelete -Commit EXPECTED RESULTS -WhatIf: the ordered plan (objects to create + scope) with NO changes. -Commit: policies/rules/tags created and the MRM policy assigned to pilot mailboxes; a summary of what was created. .NOTES White-label tooling. Write actions gated behind -Commit; -WhatIf is the default. No credentials stored. Uses standard S&C PowerShell (New-RetentionCompliancePolicy/Rule) and Exchange Online cmdlets (New-RetentionPolicyTag/Policy, Set-Mailbox); none are invented. Durations/disposition come from your records schedule (R4). Does NOT enable Preservation Lock. -IncludeArchiveTag requires archive mailboxes. > [CmdletBinding(DefaultParameterSetName = "WhatIf")] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][string]$PilotGroup, [Parameter(Mandatory)][int]$RetainDays, [ValidateSet("Retain","Delete","KeepAndDelete")][string]$Disposition = "Retain", [string]$PolicyName = "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot", [string]$RuleName = "DLCEXO-Rule-Exchange-Keep7yrThenDelete", [string]$MrmPolicyName = "DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard", [int]$DeletedItemsAgeDays = 30, [int]$JunkEmailAgeDays = 30, [int]$ArchiveAgeDays = 730, [switch]$IncludeArchiveTag, [Parameter(ParameterSetName = "Commit")][switch]$Commit, [Parameter(ParameterSetName = "WhatIf")][switch]$WhatIf)

How to run: PowerShell 5.1+ or 7+ with ExchangeOnlineManagement. Connect BOTH endpoints first: Connect-IPPSSession # Purview retention policy/rule Connect-ExchangeOnline # MRM tags/policy + mailbox assignment .\DLCEXO-Configure.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" -RetainDays 2555 -Disposition Retain -WhatIf .\DLCEXO-Configure.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" -RetainDays 2555 -Disposition KeepAndDelete -Commit EXPECTED RESULTS -WhatIf: the ordered plan (objects to create + scope) with NO changes. -Commit: policies/rules/tags created and the MRM policy assigned to pilot mailboxes; a summary of what was created. .NOTES White-label tooling. Write actions gated behind -Commit; -WhatIf is the default. No credentials stored. Uses standard S&C PowerShell (New-RetentionCompliancePolicy/Rule) and Exchange Online cmdlets (New-RetentionPolicyTag/Policy, Set-Mailbox); none are invented. Durations/disposition come from your records schedule (R4). Does NOT enable Preservation Lock. -IncludeArchiveTag requires archive mailboxes. > [CmdletBinding(DefaultParameterSetName = "WhatIf")] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][string]$PilotGroup, [Parameter(Mandatory)][int]$RetainDays, [ValidateSet("Retain","Delete","KeepAndDelete")][string]$Disposition = "Retain", [string]$PolicyName = "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot", [string]$RuleName = "DLCEXO-Rule-Exchange-Keep7yrThenDelete", [string]$MrmPolicyName = "DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard", [int]$DeletedItemsAgeDays = 30, [int]$JunkEmailAgeDays = 30,

[int]$ArchiveAgeDays = 730, [switch]$IncludeArchiveTag, [Parameter(ParameterSetName = "Commit")][switch]$Commit, [Parameter(ParameterSetName = "WhatIf")][switch]$WhatIf)

DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1

Purpose: Read-only discovery for the Exchange Lifecycle Policies solution. Inventories the two lifecycle engines already in the tenant: Purview Data Lifecycle Management retention policies/rules scoped to Exchange (Connect-IPPSSession), and Exchange MRM retention tags/policies plus the org default MRM policy, per-mailbox archive status, and litigation-hold status (Connect-ExchangeOnline). This is the "what already keeps/deletes this mail" baseline you must reconcile before adding a new policy. Changes nothing. HOW TO RUN PowerShell 5.1+ or 7+ with ExchangeOnlineManagement. Connect BOTH endpoints first: Connect-IPPSSession Connect-ExchangeOnline .\DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1 .\DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1 -IncludeMailboxSample -MailboxSampleSize 50 EXPECTED RESULTS A retention/cleanup inventory to .\DLCEXO-Lifecycle-Estate-Discovery.csv and, with -IncludeMailboxSample, a per-mailbox archive/hold/policy sample to .\DLCEXO-Mailbox-Estate-Discovery.csv. Pre-existing holds or retention that would change what a new policy removes are the first finding. .NOTES White-label Microsoft Purview / Exchange Online tooling. Read-only. No credentials stored. Cmdlets are standard S&C PowerShell and Exchange Online PowerShell; none are invented. Feature availability is licensing-dependent — the script warns where a surface is not readable rather than assuming. > [CmdletBinding()] param([switch]$IncludeMailboxSample, [int]$MailboxSampleSize = 25, [string]$OutPath = ".\DLCEXO-Lifecycle-Estate-Discovery.csv", [string]$MailboxOutPath = ".\DLCEXO-Mailbox-Estate-Discovery.csv")

How to run: PowerShell 5.1+ or 7+ with ExchangeOnlineManagement. Connect BOTH endpoints first: Connect-IPPSSession Connect-ExchangeOnline .\DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1 .\DLCEXO-Discovery.ps1 -IncludeMailboxSample -MailboxSampleSize 50 EXPECTED RESULTS A retention/cleanup inventory to .\DLCEXO-Lifecycle-Estate-Discovery.csv and, with -IncludeMailboxSample, a per-mailbox archive/hold/policy sample to .\DLCEXO-Mailbox-Estate-Discovery.csv. Pre-existing holds or retention that would change what a new policy removes are the first finding. .NOTES White-label Microsoft Purview / Exchange Online tooling. Read-only. No credentials stored. Cmdlets are standard S&C PowerShell and Exchange Online PowerShell; none are invented. Feature availability is licensing-dependent — the script warns where a surface is not readable rather than assuming. > [CmdletBinding()] param([switch]$IncludeMailboxSample, [int]$MailboxSampleSize = 25, [string]$OutPath = ".\DLCEXO-Lifecycle-Estate-Discovery.csv", [string]$MailboxOutPath = ".\DLCEXO-Mailbox-Estate-Discovery.csv")

DLCEXO-Report.ps1

Purpose: Reports the operating state of the lifecycle deployment: which mailboxes the Purview retention policy actually scopes (ExchangeLocation), MRM policy assignment coverage across the pilot/estate, archive enablement (needed for MoveToArchive), and a mailbox-size signal so you can see cleanup taking effect over time. Use it as pilot evidence and for ongoing drift/coverage assurance. Changes nothing. HOW TO RUN PowerShell 5.1+ or 7+ with ExchangeOnlineManagement. Connect BOTH endpoints first: Connect-IPPSSession Connect-ExchangeOnline .\DLCEXO-Report.ps1 -PolicyName "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot" -MrmPolicyName "DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard" .\DLCEXO-Report.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" EXPECTED RESULTS A coverage report to .\DLCEXO-Coverage-Report.csv plus a console summary (policy scope count, MRM assignment coverage, archive-enabled count). Gaps (scoped mailbox without archive for a MoveToArchive design, or pilot mailbox missing the MRM policy) are surfaced. .NOTES White-label tooling. Read-only. No

credentials stored. Standard S&C / Exchange Online cmdlets; none invented. Feature availability is licensing-dependent — the script warns rather than assuming. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$PolicyName = "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot", [string]$MrmPolicyName = "DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard", [string]$PilotGroup, [string]$OutPath = ".\DLCEXO-Coverage-Report.csv")

How to run: PowerShell 5.1+ or 7+ with ExchangeOnlineManagement. Connect BOTH endpoints first: Connect-IPPSSession Connect-ExchangeOnline .\DLCEXO-Report.ps1 -PolicyName "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot" -MrmPolicyName "DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard" .\DLCEXO-Report.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" EXPECTED RESULTS A coverage report to .\DLCEXO-Coverage-Report.csv plus a console summary (policy scope count, MRM assignment coverage, archive-enabled count). Gaps (scoped mailbox without archive for a MoveToArchive design, or pilot mailbox missing the MRM policy) are surfaced. .NOTES White-label tooling. Read-only. No credentials stored. Standard S&C / Exchange Online cmdlets; none invented. Feature availability is licensing-dependent — the script warns rather than assuming. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$PolicyName = "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot", [string]$MrmPolicyName = "DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard", [string]$PilotGroup, [string]$OutPath = ".\DLCEXO-Coverage-Report.csv")

DLCEXO-Set-Scope.ps1

Purpose: Captures the intended Exchange lifecycle scope — pilot group and its resolved mailboxes, the target retention duration + disposition, and the cleanup tag design — into a manifest you configure against. Resolving the pilot group's current members up front makes the blast radius explicit BEFORE any policy is created. Read-only: it records intent, it does not create or change any policy. HOW TO RUN PowerShell 5.1+ or 7+ with ExchangeOnlineManagement (Connect-ExchangeOnline for group resolution): Connect-ExchangeOnline .\DLCEXO-Set-Scope.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" -RetainDays 2555 -Disposition KeepAndDelete EXPECTED RESULTS A scope manifest written to .\DLCEXO-Scope-Manifest.csv (resolved pilot mailboxes + intended settings) and a one-line summary. Use it as the source of truth for DLCEXO-Configure.ps1. .NOTES White-label tooling. Read-only. No credentials stored. Group resolution uses standard Exchange Online cmdlets; none are invented. Durations/dispositions come from your records schedule (R4) — this script validates format only, not policy. > [CmdletBinding()] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][string]$PilotGroup, [Parameter(Mandatory)][int]$RetainDays, [ValidateSet("Retain","Delete","KeepAndDelete")][string]$Disposition = "Retain", [string]$OutPath = ".\DLCEXO-Scope-Manifest.csv")

How to run: PowerShell 5.1+ or 7+ with ExchangeOnlineManagement (Connect-ExchangeOnline for group resolution): Connect-ExchangeOnline .\DLCEXO-Set-Scope.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" -RetainDays 2555 -Disposition KeepAndDelete EXPECTED RESULTS A scope manifest written to .\DLCEXO-Scope-Manifest.csv (resolved pilot mailboxes + intended settings) and a one-line summary. Use it as the source of truth for DLCEXO-Configure.ps1. .NOTES White-label tooling. Read-only. No credentials stored. Group resolution uses standard Exchange Online cmdlets; none are invented. Durations/dispositions come from your records schedule (R4) — this script validates format only, not policy. > [CmdletBinding()] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][string]$PilotGroup, [Parameter(Mandatory)][int]$RetainDays, [ValidateSet("Retain","Delete","KeepAndDelete")][string]$Disposition = "Retain", [string]$OutPath = ".\DLCEXO-Scope-Manifest.csv")

DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1

Purpose: One read-only gate that checks the pilot is safe to run and safe to expand: the two toolchain connections work, the Purview retention policy is scoped to the PILOT ONLY (blast-radius), the rule matches the approved schedule, the MRM cleanup policy is assigned to pilot mailboxes, holds are visible (so held mail is preserved), and — critically — a sample of NON-pilot mailboxes is NOT carrying the policy. Prints PASS / GAP per check. Changes nothing. HOW TO RUN PowerShell 5.1+ or 7+ with ExchangeOnlineManagement. Connect BOTH endpoints first: Connect-IPPSSession Connect-ExchangeOnline .\DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" EXPECTED RESULTS A PASS/GAP line per check and an overall verdict. Overall PASS (or every GAP documented and accepted by records/legal) is the exit criterion before expanding scope or adding a delete action. .NOTES White-label tooling. Read-only. No credentials stored. Standard S&C / Exchange Online cmdlets; none invented. This gate does not make records/legal determinations — it verifies technical readiness only. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$PilotGroup = "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot", [string]$PolicyName = "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot", [string]$RuleName = "DLCEXO-Rule-Exchange-Keep7yrThenDelete", [string]$MrmPolicyName = "DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard", [int]$NonPilotSample = 5)

How to run: PowerShell 5.1+ or 7+ with ExchangeOnlineManagement. Connect BOTH endpoints first: Connect-IPPSSession Connect-ExchangeOnline .\DLCEXO-Test-Readiness.ps1 -PilotGroup "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot" EXPECTED RESULTS A PASS/GAP line per check and an overall verdict. Overall PASS (or every GAP documented and accepted by records/legal) is the exit criterion before expanding scope or adding a delete action. .NOTES White-label tooling. Read-only. No credentials stored. Standard S&C / Exchange Online cmdlets; none invented. This gate does not make records/legal determinations — it verifies technical readiness only. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$PilotGroup = "SG-DLCEXO-Pilot", [string]$PolicyName = "DLCEXO-Retention-Exchange-Pilot", [string]$RuleName = "DLCEXO-Rule-Exchange-Keep7yrThenDelete", [string]$MrmPolicyName = "DLCEXO-MRM-Cleanup-Standard", [int]$NonPilotSample = 5)